

Xingyu Su

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RESEARCH INTEREST

My research focuses on generative modeling and optimization, with an emphasis on **discrete diffusion models**, **reinforcement learning methods**, and **large language models**. I am the author of **Seq2Exp**, a framework that leverages large language models to capture causal relationships between DNA and epigenomic data for gene-expression prediction, which was selected as an oral paper at ICLR 2025. I also proposed **VIDD** (Iterative Distillation for Reward-Guided Fine-Tuning of Diffusion Models in Biomolecular Design), which develops reinforcement learning methods to fine-tune discrete diffusion models.

EDUCATION

Texas A&M University

Ph.D. in Computer Science & Engineering

- **Advisor:** Prof. Shuiwang Ji

College Station, TX

Sep 2023 – Aug 2027 (Expected)

Shanghai Jiao Tong University

Master of Science in Electronic and Information Engineering

- **Advisor:** Prof. Yanyan Shen

Shanghai, China

Sep 2020 – Feb 2023

Shanghai Jiao Tong University

Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering

Shanghai, China

Sep 2016 – Aug 2020

PUBLICATIONS

- **Xingyu Su***, Haiyang Yu*, Degui Zhi, and Shuiwang Ji. Learning to Discover Regulatory Elements for Gene Expression Prediction. International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2025, oral 1.8%).
- Masatoshi Uehara*, **Xingyu Su***, Yulai Zhao, Xiner Li, Aviv Regev, Shuiwang Ji, Sergey Levine, Tommaso Biancalani. Reward-Guided Iterative Refinement in Diffusion Models at Test-Time with Applications to Protein and DNA Design. International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2025).
- **Xingyu Su***, Xiner Li*, Masatoshi Uehara*, Sunwoo Kim, Yulai Zhao, Gabriele Scalia, Ehsan Hajiramezanali, Tommaso Biancalani, Degui Zhi, Shuiwang Ji. Iterative Distillation for Reward-Guided Fine-Tuning of Diffusion Models in Biomolecular Design. arXiv preprint arXiv:2507.00445 (2025).
- Xiner Li*, Masatoshi Uehara*, **Xingyu Su**, Gabriele Scalia, Tommaso Biancalani, Aviv Regev, Sergey Levine, Shuiwang Ji. Dynamic Search for Inference-Time Alignment in Diffusion Models. arXiv preprint arXiv:2503.02039 (2025).
- **Xingyu Su**, Xiner Li, Yuchao Lin, Ziqian Xie, Degui Zhi, Shuiwang Ji. Language Models for Controllable DNA Sequence Design. arXiv preprint arXiv:2507.19523 (2025).
- Lianhao Zhou, Hongyi Ling, Cong Fu, Yepeng Huang, Michael Sun, Wendi Yu, Xiaoxuan Wang, Xiner Li, **Xingyu Su**, Junkai Zhang, Xiusi Chen, Chenxing Liang, Xiaofeng Qian, Heng Ji, Wei Wang, Marinka Zitnik, Shuiwang Ji. Autonomous Agents for Scientific Discovery: Orchestrating Scientists, Language, Code, and Physics. arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.09901 (2025).

EXPERIENCE

The DIVE Lab, Texas A&M University

Graduate Student Researcher

Sep 2023 – Present

College Station, TX

Meituan

Recommendation Algorithm Engineer (Full-time)

Feb 2023 – Jul 2023

Shanghai, China

Intel

Machine Learning Engineer (Intern)

Aug 2022 – Dec 2022

Shanghai, China

Shanghai Jiao Tong University

Teaching Assistant

2019

Shanghai, China

AWARDS & HONORS

Graduate Research Excellence, TAMU CSE, one per year	2025
Undergraduate Merit Scholarship	2019
Fuda Scholarship	2019